

Center for Well-Being Counseling and Psychological Services SLED/RA Training 2025





Counseling &
Psychological
Senior Staff

CAPS Services

All enrolled undergraduate and graduate students are eligible for services.

Counseling services are included in Health Fee (no additional charge).

We offer testing for ADHD and other learning disabilities (there is a charge/bill to insurance).

No session limits- we offer short-term goal-oriented therapy

Corner of Finn and Grand – 200 steps from the arches!

We treat a variety of emotional issues: depression, anxiety, sexual assault, eating disorders, identity development, family issues, and more! .

Students receive individualized treatment recommendations (including off-campus referrals in necessary).

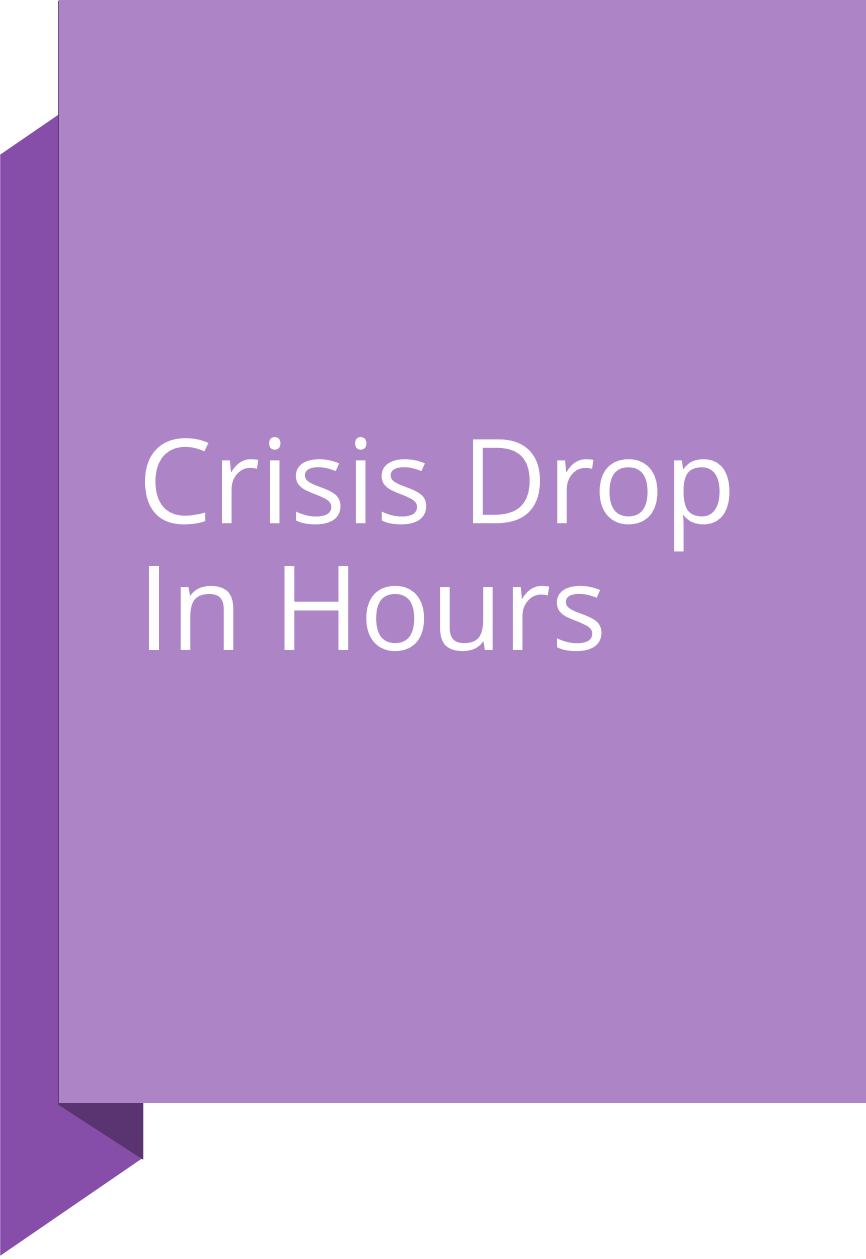


Counseling & Psychological Services: What We Offer

- Group Counseling/Workshops
- Individual Counseling
- Substance Use Resources
- Consultation/Outreach
- Crisis Drop-In (M/F 2pm-4pm)
- 24/7 Crisis Phone Counseling
- Staff Liaisons to Athletics, Veterans, LGBTQIA, OISS, SDIS, School of Nursing, and Residence Life

Groups at CAPS

- Shared Understanding – Connect with peers who “get it” and are facing similar challenges.
- Support & Encouragement – Give and receive feedback in a safe, non-judgmental space.
- Skill Building – Practice coping strategies, communication, and problem-solving in real time.
- New Perspectives – Hear different viewpoints that can shift your thinking and spark new solutions.
- Sense of Belonging – Reduce feelings of isolation by being part of a supportive community.
- Real-World Practice – Try out new ways of relating in a group before applying them in everyday life.
- Confidential & Guided – Facilitated by trained professionals to keep the group safe and focused.



Crisis Drop In Hours

- **Monday-Friday**
- **2:00 pm – 4:00 pm**
- For students experiencing immediate emotional distress for any reason
- Phone crisis counseling available 24/7
- Call 651-962-6750 Option 4
- No appointment needed
- 988- National Suicide Hotline

HELPING STUDENTS IN DISTRESS



Helping Students in Distress

- Stay Calm
- Be respectful of individual culture and identities
- **Listen**
- **Talk**
- **Extend empathy**
- Maintain Boundaries
- Refer
- Consult with your Community Director or CAPS

Active Listening

Attending Skills

- Eye contact
- Open position
- Incline your body
- Responsive motions/gesture
- Calm, relaxed state

Reflective Skills

- Validate feelings
- Open ended questions
- Invitations to continue talking
- Reflect back what you have heard and seen
- Paraphrasing
- Allow silence



Prepare:

As with anything, preparation is important.

Ask yourself these three questions before:



What's the Problem?

A resident has come to you and shared their roommate is not leaving their room and has not taken their trash out since the start of the semester.

How do I feel about it?

What do I want to be different?

I

Describe

Express

Specify

Collaborate

Summarize

DESCS

Adapted from
"Asserting Yourself" by
Bower & Bower

Describe The Situation

- Be Objective.
- Just the facts.

"I noticed that you haven't been attending any hall events or meetings. We have had a few different kinds, what keeps you from coming or what would you be interested in?."

(ANA, 2014; Bower & Bower, 2004)



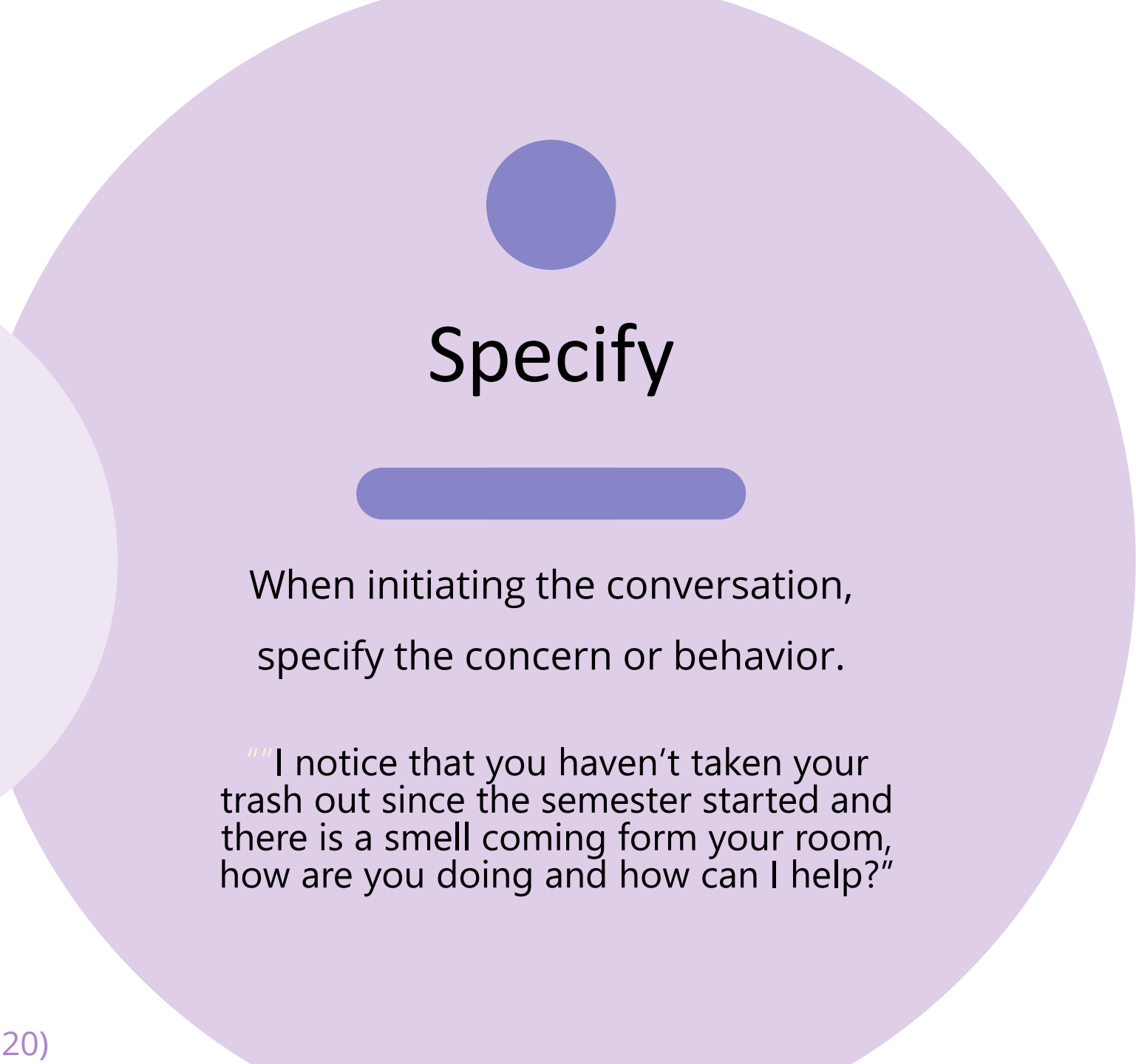
Express Your Feelings and Thoughts...

...about the situation or behavior. Try phrasing your statements using "**I**" and not "**You.**" "You" puts people on the defensive, and they will not be as open to the conversation.

""



(ANA, 2014; Bower & Bower, 2004)



Specify

When initiating the conversation,
specify the concern or behavior.

"" I notice that you haven't taken your trash out since the semester started and there is a smell coming from your room, how are you doing and how can I help?"

Collaborate Together on a Solution

- Offer an opportunity to respond or to collaborate.
- A few ways to collaborate:
 - Ask what they might need, just for you to listen or some suggestions?
 - Ask them how you can work together to ease the situation.
 - Provide a few solutions
 - Ask what they are willing to do to ease the situation.

GIVE TIME TO RESPOND!





Summarize

...or review or give thanks.

- Prevents rambling or continued repetition in the conversation.

"Thanks,, for sharing with me out. I am hearing that it's been hard to keep up with everything, and you're feeling a lot of stress."



To Level Up...

Consider this.



Don't Avoid the Problem

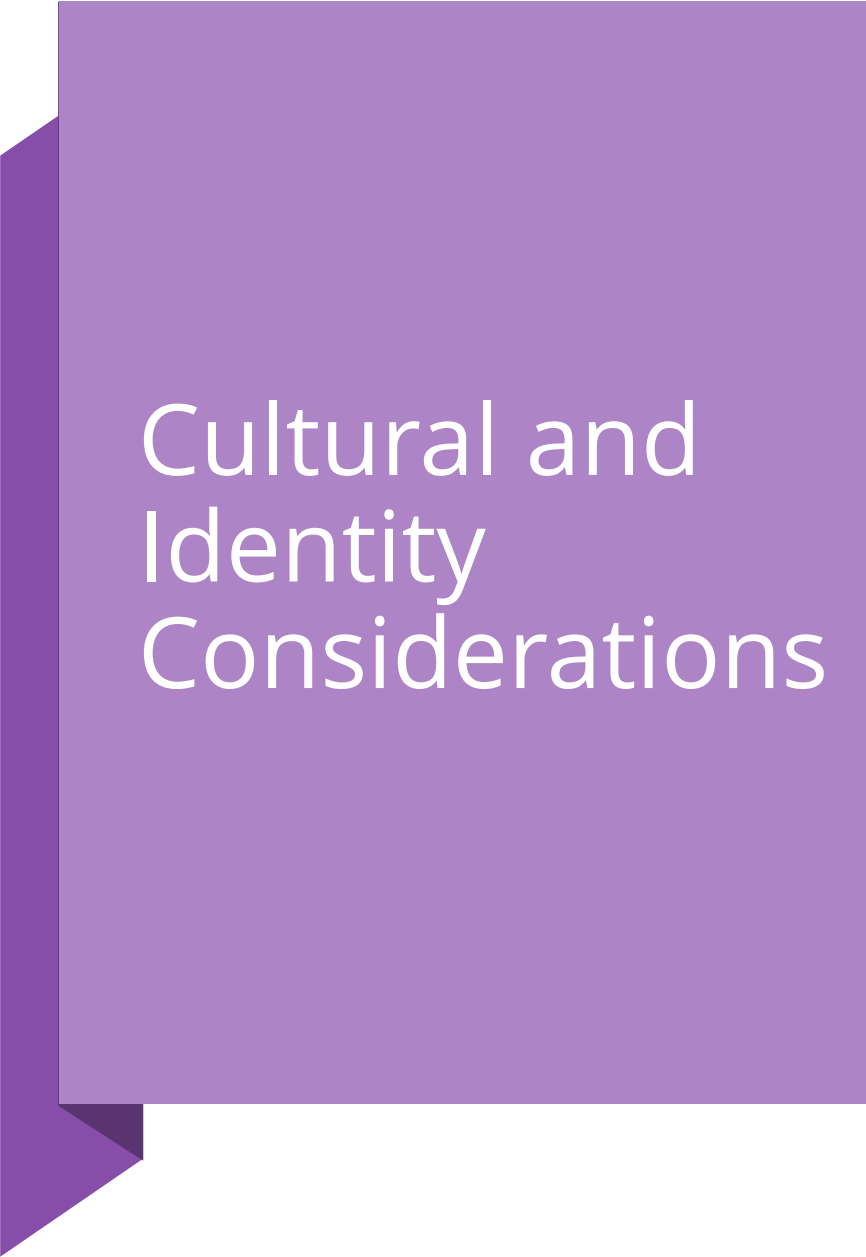
- The problem may worsen.
- Ask someone for help if unsure.

It takes Courage

- Reflect on your fear.
- Reflect if it is the right thing for you, your team, etc.

Do it with Care

- Consider their feelings.
- Consider their perspective, identities, and context.



Cultural and Identity Considerations

- Honor pronouns
- Be aware of any privilege you hold by virtue of race, gender, sexual orientation, ethnicity, or religious tradition.
- Consider the impact of racism, homophobia, transphobia.
- Some cultures may have different beliefs or stigma about seeking help for emotional distress.

Barriers to listening



- Too many distractions
- Mind wandering – drifting away
- Thinking about what to say next instead of really listening
- Jumping to advice giving – attempting to resolve problem too quickly
- Neglecting to ask if what you've heard is accurate
- Strong emotional reactions or judgment



Things to Remember..



- You are an authority figure now
- Students look up to you
- They listen and take your advice
- Don't solve their problems for them
- Let them know you care about them and want what's best for them
- Ask questions and stay curious, don't make assumptions

More Tips!



The other person may become upset.

- That's okay!
- Think about how you would like to receive feedback.

Self-compassion

- Be kind to yourself.
- Reflect on how to improve on these conversations in the future.

Making a referral to CAPS

- Normalize getting help – we all need to ask for help sometimes.
- Encourage the student to call the CWB at 651-962-6750 or walk-in to make an appointment.
- If you can, offer to walk over to the CWB with the student.
- Follow up with them at a later to check in on them.
- Continue to express your concern for their well-being.

Maintain Good Balance

- **Types of boundaries**
 - Time
 - Content
 - Emotional
- **Recognize and know your limitations**
 - What is your role as a RA?
 - What isn't your role as a RA?
 - Your needs and care for self are important to your role.
 - Seek support and help from staff.



Self-Care isn't Selfish

- Sleep
- Exercise/Movement
- Nutrition
- Social Time/Fun
- Academic
- Spiritual Practice
- Alone Time (even for extroverts)



Contact Us for Help

- **Call 651-962-6750**
- Location: 35 S. Finn St. between Grand and Summit Ave.
- Crisis Drop-In Hours: Mon-Friday 2pm to 4pm.
- 24/7 Phone Counseling 651-962-6750 Option 4

QUESTIONS?!
THANK YOU!

